

CARISTO MULENGA

Assistant Accountant | Bookkeeping, Payroll & Cost Accounting | Building Practical Finance Tools in JavaScript | ZICA Diploma

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PROFILE

Assistant Accountant with hands-on experience running payroll, cost accounting, and financial reconciliation for a 30-employee agribusiness. Builds practical finance tools, payroll dashboards, expense trackers, budget planners, for African SMEs that need clarity, not complexity, using first-hand accounting experience to inform decisions most technical builders miss. Currently pursuing the ZICA Diploma in Accountancy alongside QuickBooks, Bookkeeping, and Xero certifications.

CORE SKILLS

Accounting & Finance: Payroll Processing, Cost Accounting, Financial Reconciliation, Bank & Account Reconciliation, Sage 50 Pastel, Excel & Data Modeling, Management Reporting

Technical: JavaScript, React, HTML5 & CSS3, Git & GitHub, Problem Solving & Logic Development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Accountant — Ultimate Farms Limited

Nov 2024 – Present

Ndola, Zambia

- Handled full-cycle accounting, payroll, cost accounting, inventory tracking, and financial reporting, for a 13,500-bird layer (egg production) operation.
- Processed monthly payroll for 30 employees, ensuring accurate tax calculations, deductions, and reconciliations.
- Tracked production costs (feed, medication, labour, mortality), improving cost visibility across operations.
- Reconciled financial transactions in Sage 50 Pastel and prepared monthly management reports.
- Conducted a full audit of the company's full-year 2025 Excel workbook, correcting twelve categories of errors, including broken cross-sheet references and cost mislinks, producing a clean final cumulative figure and reconciled opening balances.
- Built Excel-based cost allocation tools, reducing manual calculation time and improving efficiency.

Founder & Operator — CayTech Printers

Apr 2022 – May 2023

Chiengi, Zambia

- Launched and scaled a self-funded printing business to 500+ clients within 13 months, with no external funding.
- Managed end-to-end operations, pricing strategy, bookkeeping, procurement, and financial reporting.
- Established cost controls and pricing models to maintain profitability in a competitive local market.
- Closed the business strategically to pursue professional accounting qualifications and long-term career growth.

Service Cashier — Logic-Zone Internet Café

Dec 2023 – Oct 2024

Chingola, Zambia

- Managed daily sales and reconciled POS transactions for 50+ customers per day with zero cash discrepancies.
- Maintained bookkeeping records in Excel and streamlined end-of-day reconciliation processes.

Logistics Assistant — Will and The Dreadz Logistics

Jun 2023 – Nov 2023

Chibombo, Central Province, Zambia

- Coordinated 50+ monthly shipments and managed expense reporting and vendor payments.
- Optimized delivery routes, reducing turnaround time by approximately 10%.

Data Entry Clerk — Chiengi District Hospital & IRS Malaria Campaign Jan 2022 – May 2023

Chiengi, Zambia · Volunteer, then paid

- Volunteered for Chiengi District Hospital's COVID-19 vaccination data entry effort (Jan–Nov 2022), entering a backlog of 2021 patient vaccination records into DHIS2 patient by patient; awarded a certificate for maintaining 99.9% data accuracy.
- Selected without application as the sole Data Entry Clerk for the district's Indoor Residual Spraying (IRS) malaria-prevention campaign (Mar–May 2023), a paid role offered directly based on performance in the volunteer programme; maintained the same 99.9% accuracy standard.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Vice Secretary — Sharing Cohorts Foundation

Jul 2025 – Present

Ndola, Zambia · Community Charity

- Managed financial records, member registers, treasury reports, and contribution trackers for a 90+ member organisation.
- Drafted and distributed meeting minutes, outreach reports, and professional correspondence.
- Produced formal governance documents, including a Constitution and By-Laws, to a professional standard.

Coordinator of Volunteers — Kawambwa District Youth Network

Dec 2018 – May 2021

Kawambwa, Zambia

- Coordinated youth programs and community outreach logistics, and maintained program documentation.

EDUCATION

Diploma in Accountancy — ZICA

Jan 2026 – Dec 2028 (In Progress)

Zambia Institute of Chartered Accountants · Accounting and Business/Management

High School Diploma — Chimpempe Secondary School

Jan 2015 – Dec 2017

Grade 12 Certificate

CERTIFICATIONS

- QuickBooks ProAdvisor Certification — In Progress
- Bookkeeping ProAdvisor Certification — In Progress
- L1 Xero Associate Certification — In Progress

REFERENCES

Available upon request